

Enterprise Cloud Strategy and Patterns

Document ID: MR-STRAT-002 | Owner: Enterprise Architecture | Status: Approved 2023

Strategic direction

Meridian Retail is cloud-first. Microsoft Azure is the approved strategic cloud platform for all new and migrated workloads. Exceptions require a formal waiver from the Architecture Review Board.

Landing zone

Workloads deploy into the enterprise landing zone: hub-and-spoke network topology, centralised identity via Entra ID, platform logging, and policy enforced via Azure Policy. All infrastructure must be defined as code.

Approved patterns

- Compute: Azure App Service or AKS for containerised workloads. Plain IaaS virtual machines require a waiver.
- Data: Azure SQL Managed Instance or Azure Database for PostgreSQL. Flexible Server are the approved relational targets.
- Messaging: Azure Service Bus is the strategic messaging platform.
- File transfer: managed SFTP on Azure Blob Storage.
- Batch: Azure Container Apps jobs or Azure Functions timer triggers replace VM cron.

Legacy middleware

IBM MQ is scheduled for retirement (date TBC). No new integrations may be built on IBM MQ. Migrating applications should plan a path to Azure Service Bus unless the retirement schedule dictates otherwise.

Migration approach

Applications are assessed using the 6R model (rehost, replatform, refactor, repurchase, retire, retain). PaaS-first: replatform is preferred over rehost where feasible within the migration window.

FinOps

All resources carry mandatory cost-centre and owner tags. Non-production environments shut down outside business hours.